just opened in town. You could do with a night out to cheer you up, so you decide to go.

The doorwoman takes one look at you.

“Not tonight” she says with an air of sniffy finality.

At that moment, a famous celebrity walks up and is ushered straight inside. Dejected and rejected you head home.

What you need is a vacation. You book yourself a two-week stay in a fancy hotel. While you are away, you give your neighbor Bob the key to your tropical greenhouse so that he can feed your carnivorous plant collection. Unknown to you, Bob throws a huge party in your back garden and invites half the town. Thankfully, due to a miscalculation they run out of drinks before any real damage is done (except to Bob’s reputation) and the party disperses. Your prized whisky selection remains safely locked away inside.

> **EXPLANATION** Beyond just identifying your users, an API also needs to be able to decide what level of access they should have. This can be based on who they are, like the celebrity getting into the club, or based on a limited-time token like a train ticket, or a long-term key like the key to the greenhouse that you lent your neighbor. Each approach has different trade-offs. A key can be lost or stolen and then used by anybody. On the other hand, you can have different keys for different locks (or different operations) allowing only a small amount of authority to be given to somebody else. Bob could get into the greenhouse